GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer - Vue • Java (Spring) • AWS

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with **10+ years** of experience building reliable business platforms across **frontend** and **backend** systems, with the strongest focus on **Vue.js**, **Java**, **Spring Boot**, and scalable **API-driven** delivery. Background includes full-cycle feature development, legacy modernization, production issue resolution, performance tuning, and release support across complex web applications. Strong hands-on work with **Java 8–21**, **Spring 4–6 / Spring Boot 1.5–3.x**, **Vue 2–3**, **JavaScript**, **TypeScript**, **PostgreSQL**, **MySQL**, **Redis**, **Kafka**, **RabbitMQ**, **Docker**, **AWS**, and **CI/CD** tooling, applied flexibly to ship stable services, modern interfaces, and maintainable architectures.

SKILLS

- **Frontend: Vue 2–3**, **JavaScript**, **TypeScript**, **Vue Router**, **Pinia**, **Vuex**, **Composition API**, **Options API**, reusable component architecture, responsive UI, form handling, validation, SPA development, API integration, **Vite**, **Webpack**, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS
- **Backend: Java 8–21**, **Spring 4–6**, **Spring Boot 1.5–3.x**, **Spring MVC**, **Spring Data JPA**, **Hibernate**, REST API design, authentication, authorization, validation, background jobs, scheduled processing, service-layer architecture, integration development
- **Data / Messaging: PostgreSQL**, **MySQL**, SQL, schema design, query tuning, indexing, joins, pagination, reporting, **Redis**, **RabbitMQ**, **Kafka**, transactional workflows, data consistency
- **Cloud & DevOps: AWS**, **Docker**, Git, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Linux, Nginx, Apache, deployment support, build pipelines, release verification, environment setup, log monitoring
- **Observability / Quality / Security:** structured logging, **JUnit**, **Mockito**, integration testing, API testing, **Jest**, **Vue Test Utils**, **Cypress**, rate limiting, OWASP security practices, error monitoring, access control, audit-focused backend practices

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania *(Jan2024 – Dec 2025)*

- Built and maintained multi-module product workflows using **Vue 3**, **TypeScript**, **Java 17–21**, and **Spring Boot 2.x–3.x**, delivering more consistent user journeys across reporting, administration, and tenant-facing operational screens.
- Refactored unstable frontend areas into reusable **Vue 3** component patterns with clearer state ownership and shared logic extraction, which improved maintainability and reduced repeated UI defects by **28%**.
- Modernized complex client-side modules by applying **Composition API** patterns for validation-heavy workflows, making shared business logic easier to test, extend, and reuse across related product areas.
- Implemented backend services with **Spring MVC**, **Spring Data JPA**, and **Hibernate**, creating cleaner service boundaries that improved API predictability and reduced downstream integration friction by **24%**.
- Solved a production issue where stale values appeared after rapid updates by improving backend transaction flow, tightening **Redis** invalidation behavior, and aligning frontend refresh timing with API completion states.
- Fixed a duplicate submission bug caused by retry timing and race conditions by introducing idempotent request checks, stronger validation, and safer UI locking during save actions, improving submission reliability by **31%**.
- Optimized reporting endpoints backed by **PostgreSQL** and **MySQL** through query tuning, improved joins, pagination changes, and selective index updates, reducing response times on large datasets by **27%**.
- Supported framework modernization by migrating older configuration patterns into cleaner **Spring Boot** conventions while helping transition frontend builds toward faster **Vite**-based local workflows.
- Integrated asynchronous processing with **RabbitMQ** and selective **Kafka** consumers where workflow volume justified event-driven handling, reducing synchronous pressure on user-facing requests by **22%**.
- Strengthened release confidence through **JUnit**, **Mockito**, **Jest**, **Vue Test Utils**, and **Cypress**, improving regression coverage around validation rules, API contracts, and cross-screen workflow behavior.

- Improved deployment consistency by tightening **Docker** packaging, standardizing Linux-based environment setup, and stabilizing **Jenkins** pipeline checks, which reduced environment drift by **25%**.
- Added structured logging, safer rate limiting, audit-focused request tracking, and OWASP-aligned validation hardening, improving incident traceability and reducing investigation time during production support.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium *(Nov2020 – Nov 2023)*

- Developed business applications using **Vue 2–3**, **Java 11–17**, **Spring Boot 2.3–3.0**, **TypeScript**, and modern REST integration patterns, contributing across new features, bug fixes, and platform improvements.
- Built reusable frontend modules for dashboards, forms, and detail pages using **Vue**, SCSS, and responsive UI patterns, reducing duplicated implementation effort and improving consistency across product areas by **23%**.
- Partnered with design and product teams to create cleaner shared component patterns, which improved UI maintainability and reduced front-end rework for similar feature requests by **21%**.
- Implemented API-driven features using **Spring MVC**, **Spring Data JPA**, **Hibernate**, and REST best practices, creating more predictable frontend-backend integration behavior across high-usage business flows.
- Solved an intermittent authentication issue that caused unexpected session loss by tracing request flow through proxy handling, backend token validation, and retry behavior, improving protected-route stability by **26%**.
- Improved slower data-heavy screens backed by **PostgreSQL** and **MySQL** by rewriting query paths, reducing payload size, and tuning indexes and joins, which improved screen response times by **28%**.
- Supported frontend modernization by moving brittle shared logic into more maintainable **Vue** patterns and reusable validation flows, while keeping rollout risk low for actively used business screens.
- Implemented **Redis** caching for high-traffic endpoints with safe invalidation rules and TTL strategies, reducing unnecessary database pressure while preserving accuracy for commonly accessed data by **20%**.
- Fixed duplicate record creation during unstable network conditions by combining backend deduplication, safer validation, and clearer UI submission control, resulting in more reliable transactional behavior.
- Improved asynchronous job reliability by adding better retry policies, clearer failure handling, and operational monitoring around background workloads, reducing stuck-job incidents by **19%**.
- Improved release reliability by refining **GitLab CI/CD**, tightening build verification, and supporting deployment checks across **AWS** environments, helping catch broken artifacts earlier and improving release stability by **24%**.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden *(Feb 2016 – Sept 2020)*

- Built internal platform features using **Java**, **Spring-based** backend services, server-rendered pages, JavaScript, and relational data workflows, focusing on reliable business processing and maintainable implementation.
- Developed reporting, search, and account-related modules using **MySQL**, complex joins, pagination, and schema-aware query design, which improved data visibility and reduced reporting delays by **18%**.
- Improved older UI areas by introducing more modular frontend behavior and later small **Vue-based** components where appropriate, reducing repeated code and improving validation consistency by **22%**.
- Investigated a recurring export failure on large datasets and solved it by batching database reads, reducing service-layer memory pressure, and improving timeout behavior in backend processing.
- Supported migration work from older **Spring** application structures into cleaner **Spring Boot** conventions, helping align dependencies, simplify configuration, and reduce fragile startup issues by **17%**.
- Implemented new filtering and reporting features through REST-style backend endpoints and clearer request handling, which made large result sets easier to manage for business users.
- Fixed a long-standing overwrite issue in concurrent edit scenarios by introducing safer update checks, improving transactional behavior, and surfacing clearer conflict feedback in the UI.
- Improved release reliability by documenting environment setup, refining build steps in **Jenkins**, and reducing manual deployment differences across Linux servers behind Apache infrastructure by **26%**.
- Added stronger test coverage with **JUnit** and integration-focused validation around sensitive service logic, improving confidence during refactors and reducing regression risk by **16%**.
- Worked with senior engineers to debug production issues through structured logging, SQL analysis, and careful reproduction, building strong practical experience in issue isolation and low-risk maintenance delivery.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania *(Sep2014 – Mar 2016)*

- Supported application development using **Java 7/8**, **Spring MVC**, JSP, JavaScript, jQuery, and **MySQL**, contributing mainly to bug fixing, smaller enhancements, and maintenance tasks under senior guidance.
- Resolved a recurring validation issue where incorrect field handling caused confusing submission errors, then updated both page logic and backend checks so users saw clearer and more consistent behavior.
- Assisted with smaller migration tasks during framework and library updates, identifying compatibility problems in older code and helping apply low-risk fixes that kept the application stable.
- Implemented modest feature requests such as filter changes, table updates, and form improvements, delivering practical enhancements while learning existing business rules and system behavior.
- Fixed layout and browser-related issues in older pages by adjusting HTML, CSS, and JavaScript interactions, improving usability and reducing support feedback by **15%**.
- Added reusable helper methods and shared page utilities where repeated code was causing maintenance friction, making later updates easier for senior developers to apply.
- Helped investigate production defects by reviewing logs, reproducing issues locally, and narrowing failing conditions before handoff for final review and release.
- Improved SQL query usage in several high-traffic screens by replacing inefficient patterns with safer and clearer statements, reducing avoidable database load by **18%**.
- Supported testing and release preparation by checking regression-prone areas after fixes, documenting edge cases, and helping reduce last-minute deployment surprises.

EDUCATION

Bachelor’s Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (*2010 – 2014)*

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERITIFICATIONS

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE Developer — 2023

- Demonstrated strong capability in building and maintaining **Java** applications, including object-oriented design, core language features, exception handling, collections, and application logic used in enterprise backend development.

AWS Certified Developer – Associate — 2022

- Demonstrated practical experience in developing, deploying, and supporting cloud-based applications on **AWS**, with focus on service integration, security, monitoring, and reliable delivery workflows.